REP-096 · Rules version 15: secret stalls (the bluffing rule)

Game	Fruit Market 1.16.0 + rules version 15 (not released; the preview copy is still rules 14)
Report date	2026-11-11 (Asia/Kuala_Lumpur)
Type	Build report
Request	"incorporate the bluffing mechanics where a player's inventory is not public and you only reveal how many fruits are you selling revealing which fruit during the price reveal phase"
Owner's answers	What opens at the bell: the first option, crates open (shelves stay hidden all game; the printed game gets a counter card per stall). What rivals may know about your shelf before the bell: the first option, nothing.
Approval	Building approved by the request and the answers (DEC-082, PLAN-073). Merging to main (preview) and publishing: not requested, not done.
Build	Branch `market-ticket-flow`, on top of the table redesign (REP-095)

1. The rule

1. **Your stall is secret.** Nobody else sees your shelf, at any time.
2. **Buying is in the open.** Everyone can watch what a stall takes from the Wholesale Market, and remember it.
3. **After stocking, one number.** When every stall is ready, each reveals how many pieces are in its crate: not which fruit, not how fresh.
4. **At the bell, crates open.** Prices and crates are revealed together: which fruit each stall sells, how many, at what price. Shelves stay hidden.

No number on any card changed. RULES_VERSION 14 to 15; computer-player version 3 to 4.

2. In the app

Where	Before	Now
Rival boxes	"$18 · 2 fruit"	"$18"; once stalls are open, "$18 · 4 out"
A rival's pop-up	Their whole shelf by freshness	Cash, perk, upgrades, favour count; "4 pieces in the crate today. Which fruit shows at the bell. The shelf stays behind the shutter."; after the bell, today's crate
Pricing screen	Every rival crate with its fruit	Every rival crate shut, with the number of pieces out
"Wanted" and "would buy" on your price rows	Worked out with the rivals' real crates	Worked out from the piece counts only
The bell	A banner, then the rush	"The bell! Every crate is open": every crate with its fruit and prices, for a few seconds, then the rush
Market lanes	"3 want, 5 in stalls"	"3 want"

Where	Before	Now
Night	Fruit dropping off every stall	Your own shelf and the market only

3. How it is kept secret

- **One view.** The engine has a new function, `publicView`, that gives the game as one stall may see it: rival shelves blank; rival crates blank from stocking to the bell, with only a count. The screen is drawn from that view, offline and online.
- **Online.** The server sends each phone only its own view. A rival's shelf is never sent; a rival's crate is not sent before the bell. A test replays a whole game and checks every step.
- **Computer stalls.** They price through a new function, `believe`, which rebuilds each rival crate as a guess from public facts: the piece count, today's orders, and the shelf the rival was seen to buy (computer stalls remember purchases; they are made in the open). The real crates are never read. A test shows a computer stall and the price suggested to a person both come out identical whether a rival put out apples or mangoes.
- **Rival purchases** still fly from the market to the rival's box, because buying is in the open.

4. The printed game

Made outside the repo and sent to the owner as PDFs at rules version 15:

- **Six counter cards** (new, two to a page): one lies in front of each shutter. Empty until the bell; then the stall's crate comes out onto it, each piece in the box with the same letter and place as on the stall sheet, with the price tags face up.
- **Shutters** stay up all game. The stall sheet and the board's beat list say "say how many, not which fruit".
- **Guidebook:** stocking ends with "Say how many"; the bell ends with every crate coming out; unsold counter pieces go back behind the shutter; the Health Inspector is paid on your own count.
- Boards and pieces: 22 pages (was 19). Cards: unchanged, 145 cards. Guidebook: 15 pages.

5. Checks

Check	Result	Evidence
`npm run verify`	PASS	437 unit tests passed, 1 skipped (as before); lint, types, palette, records, build
Secrecy tests	PASS	`tests/rules15.test.ts`, 11 tests: the view, the server, pricing without peeking, the screen
`npm run test:e2e`	PASS	npm run test:e2e: E2E OK; solo game to results with no page errors; BUDGET OK; online match 0 leaks in 100 pricing frames; six-stall room; reconnect 5 of 5
Played by script	PASS	Four and six stalls: shut crates, the bell, a rival's pop-up before and after
Balance (within 4 points)	FAIL	npm run balance: shopkeeper win rates 29.8 (Local Favourite) to 41.3 (Bargain Hunter) against 33.3 fair (rules 14: 26.3 to 41.0); rushing Premium Display 27.0, Order Book

Check	Result	Evidence
		25.0; average cash 78.5 / 94.3 / 136 for 8, 10 and 14 days (rules 14: 78.8 / 94.6 / 136.6). Not tuned.
Owner plays it on a phone	NOT RUN	Needs the preview copy (a merge to main)

6. Risks

- **It is harder to read the table.** Before the bell there is less on screen to decide from. People who do not watch rivals buy will price by feel.
- **Computer stalls remember every purchase.** That is fair (buying is public) but it is better memory than most people have. Easy stalls ignore rivals as before.
- **Computer stalls guess that rivals put out what is most wanted.** A person who learns this can fool them by doing the opposite.
- **Balance is untuned**, as in REP-094. The economy numbers moved by less than 1%.
- Unfinished rules 14 games cannot be resumed; the daily board starts fresh; older apps must update to play online.
- The repo's own print kit is still rules 13.

7. Next

Owner decides whether to merge to main (the preview copy) to play it on a phone. Publishing needs its own approval and a prepared release.